

MESA AI-NATIVE TRACK | COHORT C4 | Section A

L2 ASSESSMENT · PART B

21 September 2026

THE SCENARIO: THE GROUP TRIP THAT NEVER HAPPENS

Riya, Siddharth, Karan, Aisha, and Preethi have been trying to plan a trip together for three months. They are close friends from college, now working in different cities. The trip keeps getting postponed - not because anyone doesn't want to go, but because five people with five different schedules, budgets, and opinions cannot reach a single decision through a WhatsApp group.

The group has generated over 1,200 messages about this trip. They have zero confirmed plans.

Here is what the planning actually looks like: someone suggests a destination, a few people react with emojis, one says they can't do that weekend, someone else says "what about Goa?", and the conversation dies for two weeks. When someone brings it up again, the same cycle repeats. There is no record of what anyone actually wants, no synthesis of where preferences overlap, and no clear path to a decision - just a growing thread that everyone has quietly stopped responding to.

Riya has volunteered to coordinate. She has tried two things. First, a Google Form to collect preferences - only three of the five filled it in, and she couldn't do anything useful with incomplete responses. Second, a group poll - all five voted, but two people changed their minds the next day and the poll collapsed. She is now being blamed for the trip not happening, even though she is the only one actively trying to make it happen.

She is not looking for another WhatsApp poll. She wants a structured process: something that collects everyone's preferences - budget, dates, destination type, what they won't do - finds the options that work best for the group as a whole, and presents a clear recommendation. The group should be able to look at two or three options, understand how well each one works for each person, and make one decision. Not 200 more conversations about it.

Her ask: **"Build me a tool where everyone submits their preferences through one link, and it gives us our best trip options with everything we need to decide - including where each person stands on each option."**

What to submit:

Part 1: Due Today at 11:59 PM: Nine checks (all nine answered with evidence from this scenario) + The Cut (which part of the ask a check kills, and the one sentence you would say to Riya instead)

Part 2: Due Saturday 26 September, 11:59 PM: Components map (as an image) + the first prompt you typed into Claude Code to start the build + your live Vercel URL